

Lighting Industry Will Offer More Core Jobs for Engineers by 2020

Lighting, and especially LED lighting, has already captured a huge market and will be one of the most sought-after sectors for business and jobs in the years to come. There will be a lot more core jobs than the ones available today, once manufacturing in India gets a boost. At present, the number of jobs on the sales and managerial side is higher than technical jobs

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The opportunities in India for engineers to bag core jobs might be limited, but lighting

is an exciting and challenging field to work in, regardless of whether your interests are design, manufacturing, sales or business. There are quite a few companies offering roles in research

and development, design, testing and validation. Entrepreneurship is also a path taken by many to kick-start a venture in the lighting industry. Let us take a look at the opportunities available today.

Career in lighting industry today: An overview

- Brighter prospects for career in lighting sector by 2020, once manufacturing gets a boost
- Limited jobs in designing, testing, validation and other core areas; most jobs are sales and marketing based
- For fresh engineering graduates, salary ranges from ₹ 1,00,000 to 4,00,000 per annum
- Manufacturing industries account for a bulk of industrial demand; considerable demand from the entertainment and media sectors as well
- In terms of location, Mumbai, Delhi and Bengaluru account for most of the jobs offered in this profession
- Demand for skilled professionals is expected to increase as companies compete to transform their traditional technology offerings to more energy-efficient products
- Philips, GE Lighting, Wipro Lighting, Orient Electric, Crompton Greaves and Syska LED are some notable companies hiring people for work in lighting

You could be a designer, design assistant or design technician

Although on a limited scale, multinational companies such as Philips hire designers and design assistants for their lighting division.

Roles and responsibilities. Designers are in charge of developing a detailed design by analysing and understanding the requirements in terms of product specification. They are responsible for a detailed

Roles at a glance

Designer	Test engineer	Sales engineer
Roles, responsibilities and skills		
1. Develop a detailed design by analysing and understanding the requirements in terms of product specification 2. Work on the optimum design solution, making sure it meets specifications within boundary conditions of cost and timeline 3. Closely work with component suppliers for the right selection and electronic manufacturing service (EMS) houses for engineering/pilot runs and test labs to get the required certifications 4. Proficiency in PCB computer-aided design (CAD) software, such as Altium or Proteus 5. Basic understanding of EMS process, its critical process parameters and ability to deal with external suppliers, particularly PCB/EMS	1. In charge of LED printed circuit board assembly (PCBA) validation and testing 2. Deal with related standards, test procedures and equipment 3. Exposure to production processes of LED PCBA assembly 4. Understanding the pre-designed circuit of LED PCBA and related components 5. Knowledge on supplier capability and capacity assessment for LED PCBA and Microsoft Projects/Microsoft Office is important 6. Provide lighting-related design and consultancy support in lighting projects	1. Co-ordinate and work with the sales team at the front-end, and the marketing and technical team at the back-end, to bring the best lighting solutions to customers faster than competitors 2. Build good connections and contacts with architects to promote and introduce new products 3. Conversant with and have aptitude for lighting design and application as well as lighting software 4. Basic lighting design skills, good business development skills, ability to support regional sales teams in lighting projects under supervision, knowledge of AutoCAD, good interpersonal skills and analytical skills
Qualification expected		
Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.) or Bachelor of Technology (B.Tech.) in electronics engineering/ electronics and communication engineering		B.E. or B. Tech. in electrical or electronics. An MBA is also required by some companies